

TLC PHOTOGRAPHY

Brand Style Guide

Tender love lights the way.

Final Version — May 5, 2026

Pineville / Alexandria & Monroe / West Monroe, Louisiana

Design Philosophy: Pressed Light • Brand Concept: Two Kinds of Light

Brand Identity

Tagline

"Tender love lights the way."

Written by JP. Locked May 2, 2026.

Bio

TLC Photography is a boutique portrait studio serving central, northeast Louisiana, and beyond. The photographer behind it came from California, chose the South, and never looked back. She photographs families, couples, newborns, and graduating seniors, always chasing the moment after the pose, when the guard drops and something real surfaces. Her fiancé runs the business so she can stay behind the camera. Every image is crafted to last a lifetime and be passed to the next.

Brand Voice

Warm, not bubbly. Genuine care without exclamation points.

Southern, not folksy. The South as poetry, not parody.

Confident, not salesy. Lets the work speak. No manufactured urgency.

Poetic, not precious. Beautiful language when it serves the moment.

Vocabulary

USE: light, story, moment, legacy, heirloom, golden, quiet, real, roots, together, home, porch, natural, timeless

AVOID: slay, obsessed, epic, stunning, inspo, vibe check, hubby/wifey, bridezilla, mama bear, limited spots

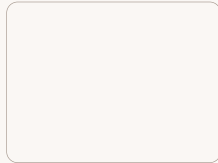
Palette A: Lavender & Sage

Daytime palette • Stable 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM • Used for all print and social media

Complete Palette



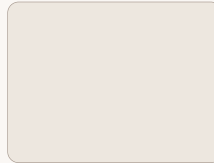
Warm Charcoal
#3A3338
Text, headings



Warm Cream
#FAF7F4
Page background



Lavender
#9B8EC4
Primary accent



Linen
#EDE7DF
Card surfaces



Soft Lavender
#DDD4EE
Hover states



Soft Taupe
#A89B91
Secondary text



Mid Sage
#C2CBB2
Botanical accent



Light Sage
#D6DCCA
Subtle fills

Typography

Headings: Cormorant Garamond Regular

Subheadings: Cormorant Garamond Light Italic

Body: Raleway Light 300

UI/Buttons: Raleway Regular 400, uppercase, 1.5px tracking

In Context

Text on cream background

Accent link color

Card on linen surface

Accent on linen

Reversed on charcoal

Light accent reversed

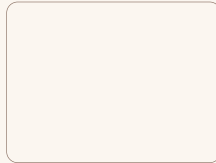
Palette B: Golden Hour

Evening palette • Stable 6:00 PM – 8:00 AM • Website only (not used in print or social)

Complete Palette



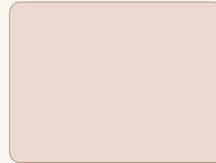
Deep Walnut
#2F2623
Text, headings



Warm Ivory
#FBF6F0
Page background



Dusty Rose
#C08B76
Primary accent



Blush
#EBD9CF
Card surfaces



Golden Honey
#C9A45C
Secondary accent



Clay
#8E7568
Secondary text



Olive Sage
#A3AB8E
Botanical accent



Wheat
#DDD0B8
Subtle fills

Typography

Headings: Fraunces Regular

Subheadings: Fraunces Light Italic

Body: Outfit Light 300

UI/Buttons: Outfit Regular 400, uppercase, 1.5px tracking

Transition Mechanics

The website transitions between palettes over 1-hour windows using 5 hand-picked color waypoints.

Evening: 5:00 PM to 6:00 PM (Lavender to Golden Hour). Morning: 8:00 AM to 9:00 AM (reverse).

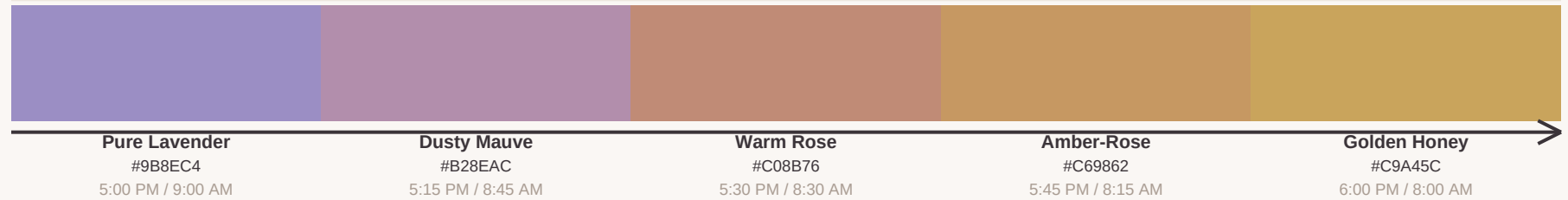
Waypoints spaced at 15-minute intervals: Pure Lavender, Dusty Mauve, Warm Rose, Amber-Rose, Golden Honey.

All palette tokens (background, surface, text, botanical, neutral) shift in parallel. No muddy midpoints.

Font swap occurs at transition endpoint (6:00 PM / 9:00 AM): 600ms fade out, swap families, 600ms fade in.

Twilight Transition

Evening Transition: 5:00 PM to 6:00 PM (Morning reverses: 8:00 AM to 9:00 AM)



How It Works

CSS custom properties define all palette colors on :root.

A JavaScript function runs on page load and every 60 seconds, calculating transition progress.

Colors interpolate between the two nearest waypoints, never across all five at once.

Each waypoint was hand-picked to preserve chromatic warmth through the entire shift.

All palette tokens (background, surface, text, botanical, neutral) transition in parallel.

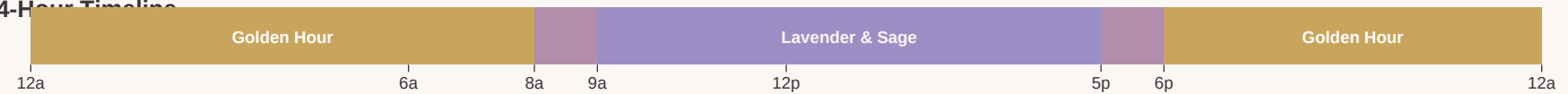
Font families swap at the transition endpoint (6:00 PM evening, 9:00 AM morning).

Swap uses a 600ms opacity fade to transparent, font-family change on :root, then 600ms fade back.

Both font families (all weights) are preloaded on page load. No flash of invisible text.

No font-size-adjust is applied. Each typeface renders at its natural proportions.

24-Hour Timeline



Typography

Type Scale (shared across both palettes)

Level	Size	Weight	Use
Hero	48px	Regular	Landing page headline
H1	36px	Regular	Page titles
H2	28px	Regular	Section headers
H3	22px	Regular	Subsection headers
Subheading	18px	Light Italic	Taglines, pull quotes
Body	16px	Light 300	Paragraph text
Small	14px	Regular	Captions, metadata
Button	14px	Regular (caps)	CTAs, navigation

Font Pairings

DAYTIME (9 AM – 5 PM)

Cormorant Garamond

Headings — Regular weight, high contrast serifs

Raleway

Body — Light 300, UI — Regular 400

EVENING (6 PM – 8 AM)

Fraunces

Headings — Regular weight, soft wedge serifs

Outfit

Body — Light 300, UI — Regular 400

Font swap at 6:00 PM / 9:00 AM: 600ms fade out, swap font-family on :root, 600ms fade in (1.2s total). Both families preloaded. No font-size-adjust.

Component Styles

Buttons

BOOK A CONSULTATION

VIEW PORTFOLIO

14px uppercase, 1.5px letter-spacing
Padding: 12px 32px, Border-radius: 4px
Hover: opacity 0.85 (primary), accent-light bg (secondary)

Cards

Card Title

Card content on cream background.
No box-shadow. 0.5px border.

Surface Card

Card on linen surface color.
No border needed. 24px padding.

Border-radius: 8px
Padding: 24px
No box-shadow

Form Inputs

Your email address

Default state

hello@example.com

Focus state: lavender border + soft lavender outline

Navigation

HOME

PORTFOLIO

SERVICES

ABOUT

BLOG

CONTACT

14px uppercase, 1.5px letter-spacing. Active state: accent color + 1.5px underline.

Layout & Spacing

Grid System

Max content width: 1200px centered

12-column grid with 24px gutters

Desktop margins: 48px | Tablet: 32px | Mobile: 16px

Spacing Scale (8px base)

xs	4px	Icon-to-label gaps	
sm	8px	Inline spacing	
md	16px	Default padding, form gaps	
lg	24px	Card padding, grid gutters	
xl	32px	Section padding (mobile)	
2xl	48px	Subsection spacing	
3xl	64px	Section padding (desktop)	
4xl	96px	Major section spacing	
5xl	128px	Hero section padding	

Common Layout Patterns

Hero: Full-bleed image, 80vh min-height, centered text overlay (max-width 600px)

Text/Image split: 5 columns text, 7 columns image, alternating left/right

Gallery grid: 3 columns, 8px gap, spanning 10 of 12 columns, centered

Section spacing: 96px vertical (desktop), 64px (mobile)

Depth, Elevation & Icons

Depth & Elevation

No box-shadows. No drop-shadows. Depth comes from background color layering.

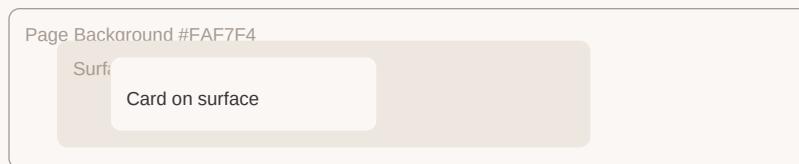
Three-layer system: page background > surface color > card background.

Thin borders (0.5px) in surface color create subtle separation.

Photography provides all visual depth and dimensionality.

Focus rings: 2px solid accent-light, 1px offset.

Material-honest aesthetic. Surfaces reference paper and linen, not glass or metal.



Icon Style: Lucide

Source: Lucide (lucide.dev), MIT license, 1500+ icons

Style: Outlined (stroke only), never filled

Stroke weight: 1.5px, rounded corners (2px), round line caps and joins

Grid: 24x24px with 2px inset padding

Color: Inherits current text color (shifts with palette)

Sizing: 16px inline, 20px buttons/nav, 24px feature blocks

Never mix icon sets. Lucide only.

Responsive Behavior

Desktop 1200px+

- Max-width 1200px centered, 48px side margins
- 12-column grid, 24px gutters
- Gallery: 3 columns
- Hero: 80vh min-height
- Section spacing: 96px

Tablet 768 – 1199px

- 32px side margins
- Collapse to 8 columns
- Gallery stays 3 columns
- Section spacing: 96px

Mobile < 768px

- 16px side margins, single column
- Gallery drops to 2 columns
- Text/image splits stack (image first)
- Hero min-height: 60vh
- Nav collapses to hamburger menu
- Touch targets minimum 44px
- Section spacing: 64px, subsection: 32px

Constants Across Breakpoints

- Type scale stays constant (Hero 48px through Button 14px)
- Color palette and transition timing unchanged
- Font families unchanged
- Image aspect ratios preserved (4:5 portrait, 3:2 landscape)

Dark Mode Variants

Optional. For dark hero sections, dark footer, or future system-preference toggle.

Lavender & Sage — Dark



Deep Charcoal
#1A171B
Background



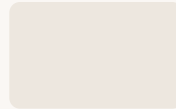
Lifted Dark
#252228
Surface



Lavender
#9B8EC4
Accent



Soft Lavender
#DDD4EE
Accent light



Light Cream
#EDE7DF
Heading text



Soft Taupe
#A89B91
Body text

Golden Hour — Dark



Deep Walnut
#1C1714
Background



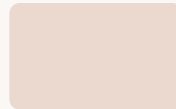
Lifted Walnut
#2A231E
Surface



Dusty Rose
#C08B76
Accent



Golden Honey
#C9A45C
Accent warm



Warm Blush
#EBD9CF
Heading text



Clay
#8E7568
Body text

Derivation Rule

Background: derived from light palette's primary text color, shifted warmer and darker.

Accent colors stay identical between light and dark modes.

Botanical colors stay unchanged (they read well on dark backgrounds naturally).

Do's and Don'ts

Do

- + Let photographs be the largest visual element on every page
- + Use generous whitespace between sections (96px minimum)
- + Keep text sparse and intentional
- + Use botanical sage/green only as small accents, never as large fills
- + Maintain warm undertones in all neutral colors
- + Use Lucide icons exclusively (1.5px outlined, round caps, 24px grid)

Don't

- Use gradients, glows, glassmorphism, or neon effects
- Mix icon sets or use filled icons
- Apply lavender or accent colors to large background areas
- Use playful, casual, or trendy design patterns
- Put more than 3 gallery columns on any screen width
- Use pure black (#000000) or pure white (#FFFFFF) anywhere
- Center-align body text (left-align always, center only for hero headlines)
- Crop photographs to circles or unusual shapes (rectangles with 4px radius only)

Social Media & Print Collateral

Social Media

All social media uses Lavender & Sage exclusively. Golden Hour is reserved for the website.

Platform	Size	Notes
Instagram post	1080 x 1350px (4:5)	Photo fills frame, wordmark bottom center at 40-60% opacity
Instagram story	1080 x 1920px (9:16)	Full-bleed photo, wordmark near bottom above swipe zone
Facebook cover	820 x 312px (~2.6:1)	Landscape photo, monogram lower-right
Facebook post	1200 x 630px (~1.9:1)	Same watermark rules as Instagram

Approved Text Overlay Combinations

Cream + Charcoal

Linen + Charcoal

Charcoal + Cream

Lavender + Cream

Watermark Rules

Horizontal wordmark at 40-60% opacity, bottom-center, 5% margin from edge

White wordmark on dark image areas, charcoal wordmark on light areas

Never full opacity, never large enough to distract from the photograph

Print Collateral

All static print materials use Lavender & Sage exclusively.

Applies to: business cards, price sheets, flyers, packaging, thank-you cards, gift certificates, album inserts.

Reasons: higher contrast for small text, photographs better under varied indoor lighting, lavender is more distinctive.

Logo System & Favicon

Logo Status: Pending

Logo and wordmark designs will be generated using Gemini with brand-specific prompts.

Vectorization via local tools: Adobe Illustrator Image Trace, StarVector, or OmniSVG.

6 prompt variants prepared: Botanical Wordmark (2 palettes), TLC Monogram, Pure Stacked, Horizontal with botanical separator, and Vine-wrapping-L exploration.

Placeholder: 'TLC Photography' in Cormorant Garamond. Monogram: T, L, C interlocked.

Required Export Formats

Format	Use Case	Specs
SVG	Web, responsive display	Clean paths, no embedded rasters
PNG	Social media, digital	Transparent, 500/1000/2000/4000px widths
PDF	Print, documents	Vector-based, CMYK color space
EPS	Print shops, legacy	Vector, outlined text
ICO	Favicon	16x16, 32x32, 48x48 multi-size
WEBP	Web performance	Transparent, sizes matching PNG

Favicon & Browser Tab

Design: TLC monogram from logo system

Sizes: 16, 32, 48, 180, 192, 512px (.ico multi-res + individual .png)

Color: Charcoal #3A3338 on transparent (no time switching)

apple-touch-icon: 180x180, monogram on lavender (#9B8EC4) background

theme-color meta: updates with palette (#FAF7F4 day, #FBF6F0 night)

og:image: 1200x630 brand card (Lavender & Sage palette)